FARES BLIBECHE

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ABOUT ME

Undergraduate data science student at Paris Sciences et Lettres – PSL University with a strong interest in Natural Language Processing, OCR[1], ASR[2], as well as their application to history, archaeology, geopolitics or cultural studies. I aim to specialize in quantitative modeling and analysis of low-resource languages and Arabic dialects, while remaining open to new experiences.

EDUCATION

Bachelor – CPES Data Science, Arts & Cultures 2024 – now
PSL University & Lycée Louis-Le-Grand (Paris, France)
Selective, multi-disciplinary curriculum in Mathematics, Data Science, Algorithmics, and Cultural Sciences.

Classes Préparatoires aux Grandes Écoles (CPGE) – MP2I 2023 – 2024
Lycée Hoche (Versailles, France)
Highly selective French program preparing for competitive entrance exams for engineering and research schools in Mathematics, Physics, and Computer Science.

Baccalaureate – Mathematics and Physics 2022 – 2023
Lycée Marie Curie (Sceaux, France)
Graduated with Highest Honors.

EXPERIENCES & INTERNSHIPS

PROCLAC Lab | Research Intern 2025 – now
Collège de France, École Pratique des Hautes Études (EPHE) & CNRS.
Codicology and manuscript analysis using HTR [3] methods and data collection of 15th-century Arabic and Aljamiado manuscripts.
Supervisors: Riham Mokrani & Prof. Nurilla de Castilla

INVOLVEMENTS

Al-Adab Association | Member 2026 – now
Promoting Arab cultures and dialogue through films, debates, and student events.

CPES Student Union | Elected Representative 2025 – 2026
PSL University
Coordinating team efforts, planning student events, and mentoring first-year students.

Carthago Nostrum Association | Member 2019 – 2023
Promoting Tunisian culture and debates. Editing video content, including interviews with historians and journalists (e.g., Sophie Bessis).

High School Tutoring 2022 – 2023
Lycée Marie-Curie (Sceaux, France)
Providing support in mathematics, physics, and informatics to other high school students.

SKILLS

* **Mathematics:** Second-year undergraduate level, with a solid grasp of core tools in analysis and algebra.
* **Data Science:** Able to apply standard models using scikit-learn, including logistic, ridge, and multivariate regression, neural networks, and basic NLP embedding models.
* **Programming:** Proficiency in Python. Basic skills in C, OCaml, and LaTeX.
* **Physics:** Knowledge in physics and industrial science (CPGE level).
* **Languages:** French (native), Tunisian Arabic (native), English (C1), Classical Arabic (A2), Italian (A1).
* **Additional languages:** Basic knowledge of Russian and German (studied at high school), Basic knowledge of Latin and Ancient Greek (2 years in middle school).

SOME READINGS

* AraBERT: Transformer-based Model for Arabic Language Understanding, *Proceedings of the 4th Workshop on Open-Source Arabic Corpora and Processing Tools*, pages 9–15, Wissam Antoun *et al.*
* Universal Automatic Phonetic Transcription into the International Phonetic Alphabet, Chihiro Taguchi, Yusuke Sakai, Parisa Haghani, David Chiang, pages 9–15
* Currently reading *Al Muqaddima*, Ibn Khaldoun, 1377

HOBBIES

* **Music:** Self-taught Ney and Oud. Oboe at conservatory. 3rd cycle music theory with highest honors. Composition on MuseScore.
* **Sports:** Road cycling in a club.

[1] Optical Character Recognition [2] Automatic Speech Recognition [3] Handwritten Text Recognition